Service Instructions

FORM 3A NOTICE

Purpose: Use these instructions to serve the Form 3A notice consistently and preserve evidence of when, where, and how service took place.

The claimant seeks possession of 16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX relying on Ground 8 (Rent arrears), Ground 10 (Any rent arrears).

Form 3A notice served on 30 April 2026, expiring on 28 May 2026, with proceedings not intended before 28 May 2026.

PROPERTY	**16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX**
TENANT	**Ivy Carleton**
NOTICE	**Form 3A notice**
NOTICE SERVICE DATE	**30 April 2026**
NOTICE EXPIRY DATE	**28 May 2026**
EARLIEST PROCEEDINGS DATE	**28 May 2026**

Recommended Service Method

First Class Post

- Send the Form 3A notice by Royal Mail first class post.
- Keep the proof of posting receipt and a copy of the notice served.
- Record the date of posting and keep any follow-up correspondence.
- Keep the service date and earliest proceedings date consistent across the notice, the N215 certificate, and any later court papers.

Practical Method Notes

- Keep the proof of posting, a copy of the served Form 3A notice, and a record of the address used.
- If service is challenged, be ready to explain why the method chosen complied with the tenancy agreement and why the service date used in the pack is the correct date.

Electronic service: Do not rely on email or text alone unless the tenancy terms clearly permit electronic service and you are satisfied the clause applies to notices of this kind.

Evidence To Keep

Service Evidence Checklist

- Served copy of the notice
- Completed Form N215 certificate of service
- Updated rent statement and arrears schedule
- Payment ledger, bank statements, or rent receipts
- Copies of payment demands or arrears correspondence

After Service

Next Steps

- Record immediately when, where, and how service was carried out.
- Keep the notice timeline consistent across the proof of service, witness statement, and court forms.
- Update the arrears schedule to the latest practicable date before issuing proceedings or attending any hearing.

Important: Incorrect service or weak service evidence can delay or undermine the possession claim even where the factual grounds are otherwise strong.

Common Mistakes To Avoid

- Using one service date on the notice and a different date in the support documents.
- Leaving unsupported allegations in the pack without the document or witness material needed to prove them.
- Relying on a stale arrears figure or an outdated payment schedule.

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